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AS AMENDED

By: Norwood of the House

Gillespie of the Senate

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16 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 10 O.S. 2021, Section 601.6, as
17 amended by Section 1, Chapter 178, O.S.L. 2025 (10 O.S. Supp. 2025,
18 Section 601.6), is amended to read as follows:

19 Section 601.6. A. For purposes of this section, the term
20 "children and youth service system" shall have the same meaning as
21 it is defined in Section 600 of this title.

B. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall have the responsibility of inspecting and investigating misfeasance and malfeasance within the children and youth service system, as

1 directed by the Oklahoma Commission on Children and Youth, to
2 ascertain compliance with established responsibilities.

3 C. The Office shall conduct not less than one but not more than
4 two regular, periodic, unannounced inspections of state-operated
5 children's institutions and facilities annually. The Office is
6 further authorized to inspect privately operated children's
7 institutions and facilities that receive state or federal funding,
8 on a periodic basis or as needed.

9 D. The Office shall investigate complaints filed with the
10 Office regarding the children and youth service system.

11 E. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall have the
12 authority to:

13 1. Access all facilities within the children and youth service
14 system for the purpose of conducting inspections and investigations;

15 2. Examine and copy all records and budgets pertaining to the
16 children and youth service system and to review inspection reports
17 of the State Fire Marshal, State Department of Health, and any other
18 agency that accredits such institutions and facilities;

19 3. Interview the residents of institutions and facilities
20 within the children and youth service system;

21 4. Subpoena witnesses and hold public hearings;

22 5. Establish, in accordance with the Dispute Resolution Act,
23 Sections 1801 through 1813 of Title 12 of the Oklahoma Statutes, a
24 voluntary program for foster parents to mediate complaints

1 concerning the rights of foster parents, as provided for in Section
2 1-9-119 of Title 10A of the Oklahoma Statutes, that relate to
3 certain actions, inactions or decisions of the Department of Human
4 Services, the Department of Juvenile Justice, or child-placing
5 agencies that may adversely affect the safety and well-being of
6 children in the custody of the state;

7 6. Receive any complaint alleging that an employee of the
8 Department of Human Services or a child-placing agency has
9 threatened a foster parent with removal of a child from the foster
10 parent, harassed a foster parent, or refused to place a child in a
11 licensed or certified foster home, or disrupted a child placement as
12 retaliation or discrimination towards a foster parent who has:

- 13 a. filed a grievance pursuant to Section 1-9-120 of Title
- 14 10A of the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 15 b. provided information to any state official or
- 16 Department employee, or
- 17 c. testified, assisted, or otherwise participated in an
- 18 investigation, proceeding, or hearing against the
- 19 Department or child-placing agency.

20 The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall forward the
21 complaints to the Office of Client Advocacy for investigation
22 pursuant to subsection D of Section 1-9-112 of Title 10A of the
23 Oklahoma Statutes. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall
24 work with the Office of Client Advocacy to ensure the complaints are

1 investigated and resolved in accordance with the grievance
2 procedures provided in Section 1-9-120 of Title 10A of the Oklahoma
3 Statutes. The provisions of this paragraph shall not apply to any
4 complaint by a foster parent regarding the result of a criminal,
5 administrative, or civil proceeding for a violation of any law,
6 rule, or contract provision by that foster parent, or the action
7 taken by the Department or a child-placing agency in conformity with
8 the result of any such proceeding;

9 7. Issue reports to the Governor, Speaker of the House of
10 Representatives, President Pro Tempore of the Senate, Chief Justice
11 of the Supreme Court of the State of Oklahoma, any appropriate
12 prosecutorial agency, the director of the agency under
13 consideration, and other persons as necessary and appropriate; and

14 8. Provide recommendations to the Oklahoma Commission on
15 Children and Youth on or before May 1 of each year.

16 F. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall not release
17 information that would identify a person who makes a complaint to
18 the Office, unless a:

19 1. A court of competent jurisdiction orders release of the
20 information for good cause shown; or

21 2. The disclosure of such information is made to an appropriate
22 law enforcement agency when necessary to protect the safety of
23 others after a complainant communicates a threat against an
24 individual or entity that a reasonable person would interpret as a

1 serious expression of intent to commit an act of unlawful violence.
2 Such information shall not be disclosed to any other person or
3 entity except pursuant to an order of a court of competent
4 jurisdiction.

5 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

6 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES
7 April 13, 2026 - DO PASS AS AMENDED
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